

BOWLNA – Founder Journal (v1)

Phase 1: Identifying the Opportunity

Observation: No scaled Indian equivalent of Chipotle/Cava in the US. Indian food perceived as heavy, complex, and not customizable.

Insight: The format is broken—not the cuisine.

Phase 2: Defining the Format

Decision: Bowl-based system with warm bowls.

Hypothesis: Warm bowls increase comfort and repeat usage.

Phase 3: Hybrid Model

Decision: BYOB + Signature Bowls.

Insight: Signature bowls act as conversion tools and reduce decision fatigue.

Phase 4: Product Architecture

Breakthrough: Gravy-based system as core differentiator.

Insight: Flavor depth in Indian food comes from sauces, not toppings.

Phase 5: Portioning

Decision: Standardized 2 oz gravy.

Learning: Fullness perception is driven by composition, not quantity.

Phase 6: Menu Simplification

Principle: Not maximum choice—optimal choice.

Phase 7: Brand Creation

Positioning: Modern Indian bowl brand.

Core Idea: Comfort + Control.

Hero Line: Your Bowl. Your Way.

Phase 8: Design

Colors: Sage Green and Turmeric Yellow.

Motif: Steam line storytelling across the store.

Phase 9: Pricing

Strategy aligned with Chipotle/Cava tiers (\$9.99–\$13.99).

Phase 10: Operating Model

Assembly line with centralized gravy production for scalability.

Phase 11: Go-To-Market

Start with Microsoft corporate locations → optimize → expand.

Key Learnings

1. Format > Cuisine
2. Simplicity Wins
3. Perception Engineering Matters
4. Signature Bowls Drive Adoption
5. Operations Drive Brand